



FOCUS ON... PRASEODYMIUM

This lanthanide metal has a range of uses, from colouring glass to making alloys for powerful magnets.



▲ Artificial gems, such as this cubic zirconia, are dyed green using praseodymium.



▲ Praseodymium is mixed with magnesium to make superstrong alloys for aircraft engines.

Cerium

58
Ce

Of the rare earth elements, cerium is the most common. It is even more common in Earth's rocks than copper or lead. Cerium is used to make touchscreens on devices, some batteries, and glass polish.



Black crystals of allanite, an ore of cerium

ATOMIC MASS 140.116

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1803 (Baron Jöns Jacob Berzelius and Wilhelm Hisinger), 1803 (Martin Klaproth)

Praseodymium

59
Pr

The name of this metal, which means “green twin” in Greek, refers to how pure samples of praseodymium will transform into a flaky green chemical when left in the air. Glasses tinted with praseodymium have a yellow colour and make it easier to see in dark conditions.

ATOMIC MASS 140.908

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1885
(Carl Auer von Welsbach)



Chunk of monazite, an ore of praseodymium